

The Antivirus Details								
Name	Antivir 9x	AVG	eScan	F-Secure	InoculateIT	McAfee 5.1	Norton AntiVirus 2001	QuickHeal 6.01
Contact	Free AV	Grisoft	Microworld Software Services	Crystal Solutions Pvt Ltd	Computer Associates	McAfee	N&N Systems and Softwares	Cat Computer Services
Price	-	-	Rs.1800	Rs.2500	-	Rs 1,200	Rs 1,600	Expree-Rs.500 Standard -Rs.1800
Phone number	-	-	022-8265701	022-5093111	-	-	022-4444601	020-6122173
Fax number	-	-	022-8344750	022-5093112	-	-	022-4465097	020-6122173
Web site	www.free-av.com	www.grisoft.com	www.mspl.net	www.f-secure.com	http://antivirus.cai.com	www.mcafee.com	www.symantec.com	www.quickheal.com
E-Mail	-	-	vig@mspl.net	-	-	-	info@bom.nandn.com	cat@vsnl.com
Features								
E-mail checking	NO	YES	YES	NO	NO	YES	YES	YES
DOS bootup check	NO	YES	NO	NO	NO	YES	YES	YES
Browsing virus scan	NO	NO	NO	NO	YES - proxy	YES	YES	YES
Download scan	NO	NO	NO	NO	NO	YES	YES	YES
Script blocking	NO	NO	NO	NO	NO	YES	YES	NO
Compressed File Scanning	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES
Performance								
Viruses detected (uncompressed)	98.96%	90.59%	92.39%	92.38%	97.12%	91.08%	89.09%	57.11%
Viruses detected in compressed files	23.57%	92.87%	crashed	2.23%	92.06%	crashed	85.44%	crashed
Time taken to scan compressed viruses	0.06 seconds	0.04 seconds	crashed	0.40 seconds	0.04 seconds	crashed	0.34 seconds	crashed
Resource (MB of RAM used)	2.5	2	4.6	9.3	3.5	4	4.5	1
Boot up time difference	3	22	19	22	7	15	35	9
Rating	B	B+	B-	C+	B+	B+	A-	B-

detected or cleaned. F-Secure has a log that opens up as an HTML page in your browser. Norton has one of the best interfaces, while McAfee comes a close second.

Get the update

Even if the antivirus software gives good detection rates, there's no way the software can keep track of the new viruses coming up every day. The only way to be up-to-date is by regularly installing updates to the signature or virus definition file. The software normally allows for automatic updation of files or you can download the updates from the Net. Earlier, while updating the definition files, you had to manually stop the auto-protect feature, copy the definition files to the directory where the software is installed, and then restart the machine. Now, you can dispense with this manual process. The antivirus program updates the file on its own without even asking for a restart.

In McAfee, updating your virus definitions can be a bit time-consuming because sometimes the entire scanning engine is updated instead of just the virus

definitions. There is no concept of progressive updates—that is, if you update your virus definition files for a particular week, the next time you update, you should just be given only the new virus definition files.

Some software also give you options for what you want to update. You can choose just to update the rescue disk, the virus definition files, or even the scanning engine. F-Secure offers you even more options wherein you can select the categories of definition files (macro, boot sector, etc) that you want to update. You can select the automatic update feature or even schedule updates, but for that you have to be online at the time you have scheduled the update, and with a dial-up line this might not always be possible. Norton even supports a feature wherein you can send a suspicious file for scanning at their research labs.

CONCLUSION

Among the viruses that were tested, InoculateIT, AVG and Antivir are really coack-ages that you can look forward to for general system security. Antivir has a good virus definition set, and had the maximum detection rate. InoculateIT also had quite a good detection rate, and it did well in checking for viruses within compressed files.

AVG had a problem in cleaning some of the infected files and therefore lost out on that count. In spite of impressive features, McAfee failed in detecting viruses within compressed files.

The best all-round performer was **Norton AntiVirus 2001**. Good detection and cleaning rates, excellent features and Live Update options truly make it the best performer. True, it's a bit resource-hungry, but what the heck, you can compromise that much to keep your system bug-free. ■

